Part 2

Scale, reliability and what breaks · AI Visibility Audit (Skillsoft Percipio sample)

1. Our current process

How it works (the Part 1 tool): our own script opens a real browser, asks each question on the public, logged-out AI platforms, saves the answer, and finds brand mentions, positions, competitors and sources with plain text matching. It uses no AI and needs no API keys.

Scaled to the brief: 500 brands × 50 questions × 3 platforms × **3 runs a month** = **225k answers a month**.

The brief says daily, but to understand market trends and a brand's current position you don't need daily runs. AI models, and the way they retrieve information in the background, don't change from day to day. What matters is collecting enough answers to catch the trends and position our clients accurately. So each question runs 3 times a month, spread across weeks 1, 2 and 3.

Cost per month

Assumptions: ~45 seconds per answer; one cloud server runs 5 browsers for ~$130/month; many IP addresses are needed at this volume, at ~$0.002–0.01 per answer.

Cost line	Per month
Servers (1 server, ~4 browsers)	~$0.15k
IP/network capacity	~$0.45–2.3k
Total	**~$0.6–2.4k**

Reliability

1. **Answers can change between runs, but usually not by much.** The exact wording and order differ, but the same brands tend to keep coming back.
2. **Blocking.** At small volume it works: Part 1 got 20/20 answers with no CAPTCHAs on ChatGPT and Gemini. But Google blocked us on the very first search, so at scale blocks will leave gaps in the data.

What can break

1. **Blocking and CAPTCHAs:** platforms detect the scraper and stop answering.
2. **Page changes and outages:** a layout change breaks the parser, or a platform goes down for hours.

2. The Fix

Cost: ask per industry, not per brand

Brands in the same industry get asked the same questions. Skillsoft and Docebo both care about "What's the best LMS for a mid-size company?". So we **ask each question once and score every brand in the answer.** Our analysis needs no AI, so scoring an extra brand costs nothing.

Assumptions: the 500 brands fall into ~10 industries × 3 countries = 30 question sets of 100 questions each, plus 10 brand-specific questions per brand ("Skillsoft vs Docebo", "Is Percipio worth it?"). Each brand is measured on 110 questions instead of 50. Everything still runs 3 times a month.

Answers per month

- Shared sets: 30 × 100 × 3 platforms × 3 runs = 27k
- Brand questions: 500 × 10 × 3 platforms × 3 runs = 45k
- **Total: ~72k answers a month instead of 225k**

Cost line	Current (per brand)	The Fix (per industry)
Answers/month	225k	~72k
Servers	~$0.15k	~$0.1k
IP/network capacity	~$0.45–2.3k	~$0.15–0.7k
CAPTCHA solving (new, see below)	–	under $0.1k
Total	**~$0.6–2.4k**	**~$0.3–0.9k**

About 3× cheaper and more than twice the questions per brand: under $2 per brand per month.

Extra savings

- Use one global question set where countries barely differ (e.g. video calls), and per-country sets only where they do (e.g. payroll, payments).
- Try the free CAPTCHA solver first and pay only when it fails.
- Offer weekly runs as a paid add-on for clients actively doing GEO work who want to see results sooner.

Reliability

Fixing the blocking gap: CAPTCHA solvers. When a scraper hits a CAPTCHA, it goes down a fallback chain:

open-source CAPTCHA solver (free) → paid CAPTCHA-solving API → official platform API (last resort, labelled as an estimate)

At an assumed 10–30% CAPTCHA rate and ~$1–3 per 1,000 solves, this costs under $100 a month.

Fixing answer variation: test first, then measure with statistics.

- **Trial runs first:** before launching an industry set, ask each question about 10 times to measure how much the answers really vary. Stable questions keep 3 runs a month; questions that vary more get extra runs.
- **Report how often a brand appears:** "mentioned in 45% of answers", not single answers.
- **More answers per brand, statistical tests that flag only real changes, fixed test conditions and a saved answer behind every number make the results trustworthy enough to show a client.**